31 OCT — 7 NOV 2026 · PRESERVED IN SEQUENCE

# Four dispatches. One open case.

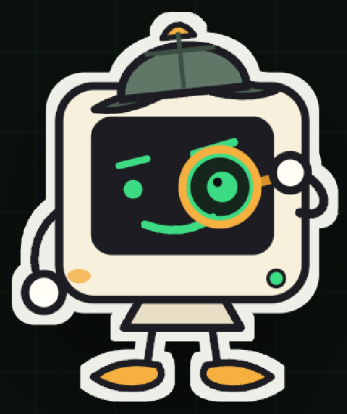
The campaign changed as replies arrived. This archive preserves each published chapter—and shows how the questions became an investigation.

01 **Survey launch**
QUESTIONS BEFORE EVIDENCE
7 PAGES

02 **Early numbers**
THE FIRST WEEK SNAPSHOT
9 PAGES

03 **Rootie case file**
THE INVESTIGATION LENS
7 PAGES

04 **Missing-profiles dossier**
EVIDENCE WITH CALIBRATED CLAIMS
9 PAGES



READING NOTE / EVOLVING SURVEY

**Counts change because the survey remained open. Every chapter keeps its original snapshot; later chapters supersede earlier totals.**

EARLY STATISTICS ARCHIVE · CAREERS, SKILLS, PAY AND COMMUNITY

# What this Morocco cybersecurity survey covers.

State of Sec Morocco documents early respondent perspectives on cybersecurity work, learning, opportunity, mobility, representation and responsible disclosure.

CYBERSÉCURITÉ MAROC · ENQUÊTE CYBERSÉCURITÉ MAROC · الأمن السيبراني في المغرب

## 01 Workforce & careers

Employment, students, freelancers, SOC and blue teams, offensive security, GRC, CISOs and management.

## 02 Certifications & learning

OSCP, CompTIA, INE and HTB, network vendors, CISSP, CISM, CISA, ISO 27001 and entry-level options.

## 03 Pay & bug bounty

Compensation questions and bug-bounty earnings reported in USD for the preceding 12 months.

## 04 Geography & mobility

Morocco's 12 official regions, the diaspora and intentions to work abroad within two years.

## 05 Representation

Women in cybersecurity and professional profiles underrepresented in the respondent sample.

## 06 Disclosure & trust

Security flaws noticed, responsible disclosure and perceptions of legal protection in Morocco.

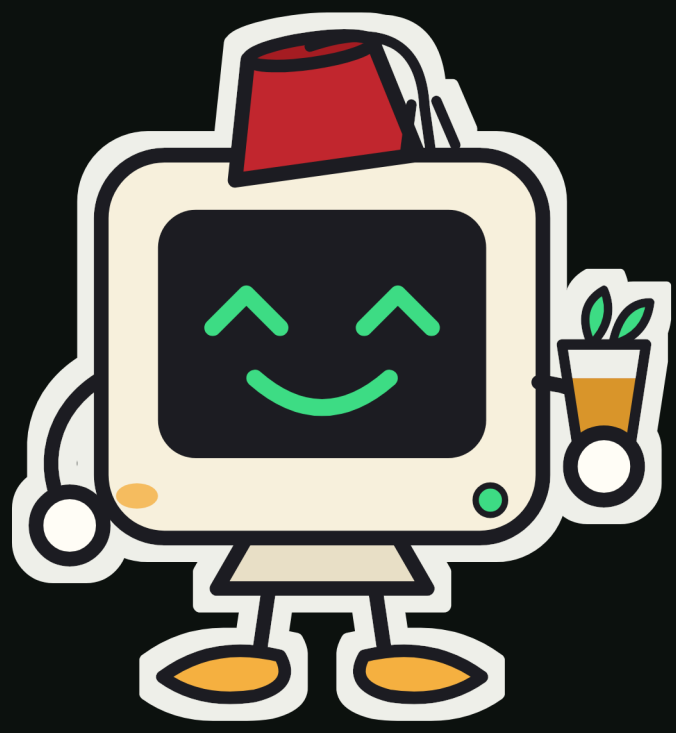
SCOPE / EARLY RESPONDENT SNAPSHOTS

**This is not a nationally representative workforce report. Later chapter counts supersede earlier snapshots.**

Report author: **Salah-Eddine El Ouali (@saladin0x1) · saladin.su.** A not-for-profit community project by @saladin0x1 and @mchklt, inspired by **stateofdev.ma**, GeeksBlaBla and its contributors. **Explore stateofsec.ma.**

# What do security people in Morocco actually earn?

Nobody has the numbers.



State of Sec Morocco

stateofsec.ma

# Ask 5 security people what they earn.

# You'll get 5 guesses.

Same for the certs that actually get you hired, or what happens when you report a vulnerability.

Today, it all runs on DMs and rumors.

SO WE BUILT

# State of Sec Morocco

An annual, anonymous survey of Morocco's cybersecurity professionals.

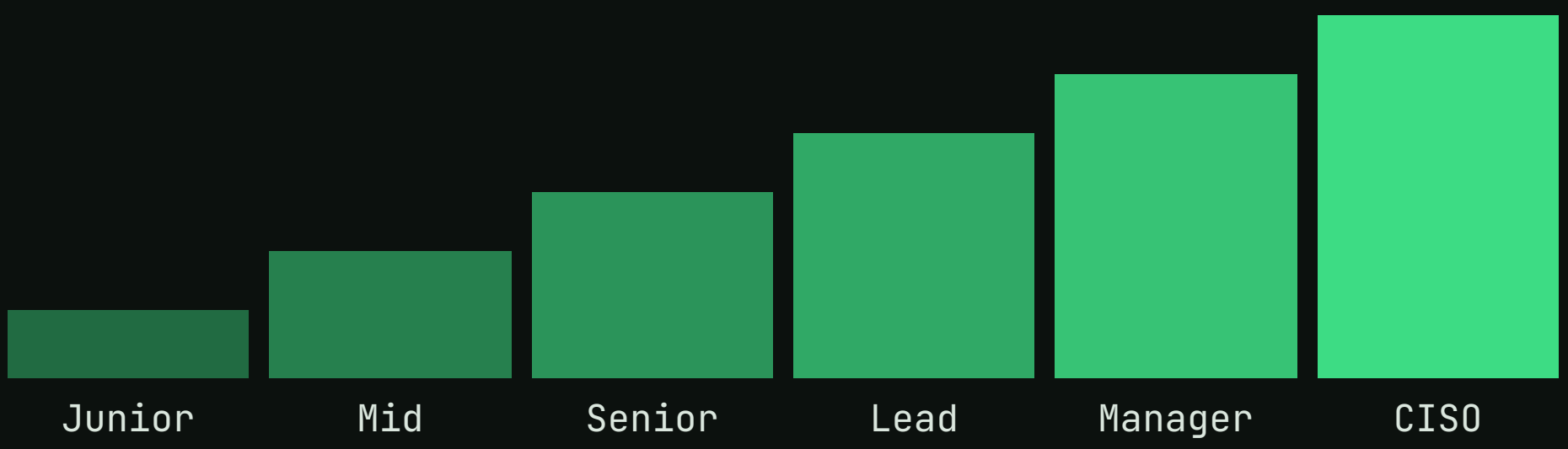
Built in the open, by people from the field.

# Every field.
# Every level.

FIELDS

- Offensive security
- SOC / blue team
- Incident response
- AppSec
- Cloud
- GRC
- Network & infra
- Threat intel & RE
- Security engineering
- CISO / management

LEVELS




In Morocco or abroad.

# What the results will show

01 Salaries by role and level

02 Certifications that pay off

03 Careers, from junior to CISO

04 Bug bounty, from Morocco

05 What happens when you report a flaw

# Three rules.

01 **Anonymous**

No name, no email. A random session only stops spam.

02 **Open results**

A public report, with the totals behind every chart.

03 **Open source**

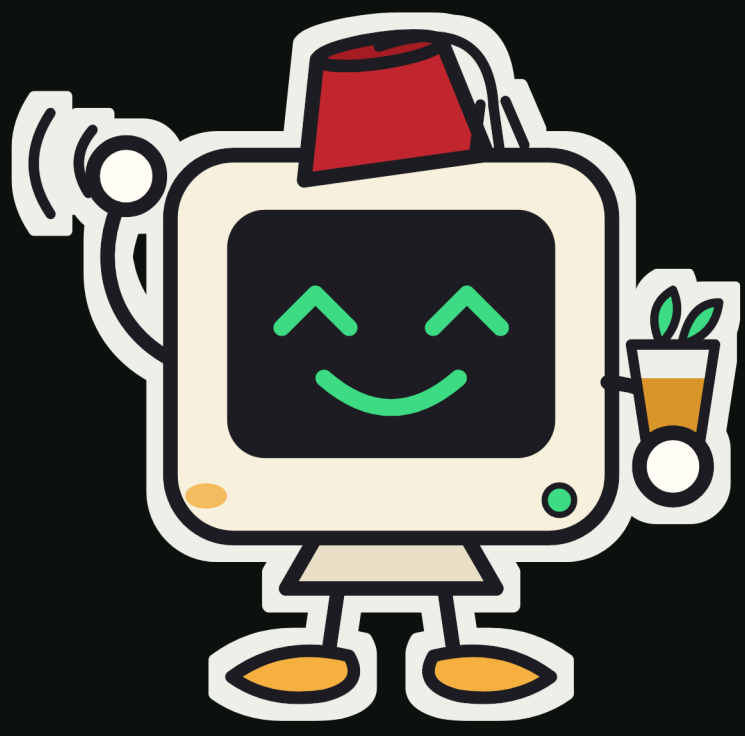
The code and every question are on GitHub.

Inspired by stateofdev.ma, by the GeeksBlaBla community.

# The first edition is open.

About 10 to 15 minutes. No name, no email.

stateofsec.ma



CHAPTER 01 LOGGED · THE SURVEY IS LIVE

# The questions went out. The first signals came back.

The opening invitation established the unknowns. One week later, there was enough evidence for a first snapshot.

PREVIOUS DISPATCH / 01

## Survey launch

Questions about pay, skills, work and community.

OPEN CALL · 7 PAGES

NEXT DISPATCH / 02

## Early numbers

The first response patterns enter the record.

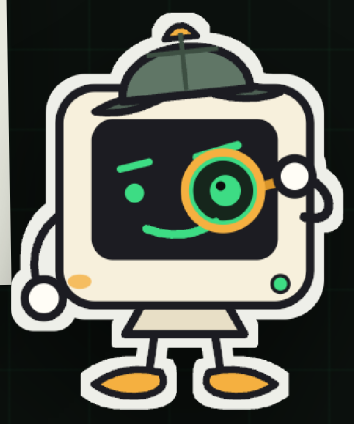
WEEK ONE · 9 PAGES

TURN THE FILE

WHY THE COUNTER RESETS

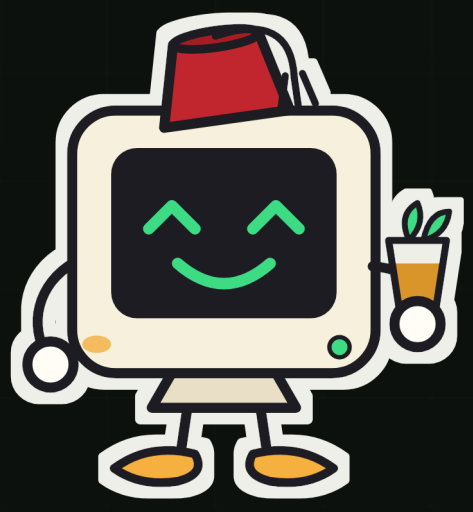
### Each original carousel keeps its published page count.

The divider marks the hand-off; the next chapter intentionally begins at 1/9.



FIELD UPDATE · WEEK 1 · 7 NOV 2026

# State of Sec Morocco: the early numbers.



**260+ practitioners & students** from **all 12 Moroccan regions** and the diaspora have answered. Here is what the early data says.

| 260+ | 12/12 | 21 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| People so far | Moroccan regions | Answers from abroad |

DEMOGRAPHICS

# Who answered so far?

A real cross-section of Morocco's cyber scene.

**30%** Employees in Morocco
Security firms, public administration, ESNs, banks

**29%** Students
Universities and public schools first, then private, OFPPT & 1337

**14%** Freelancers & bug bounty
Full-time hunters and independent consultants

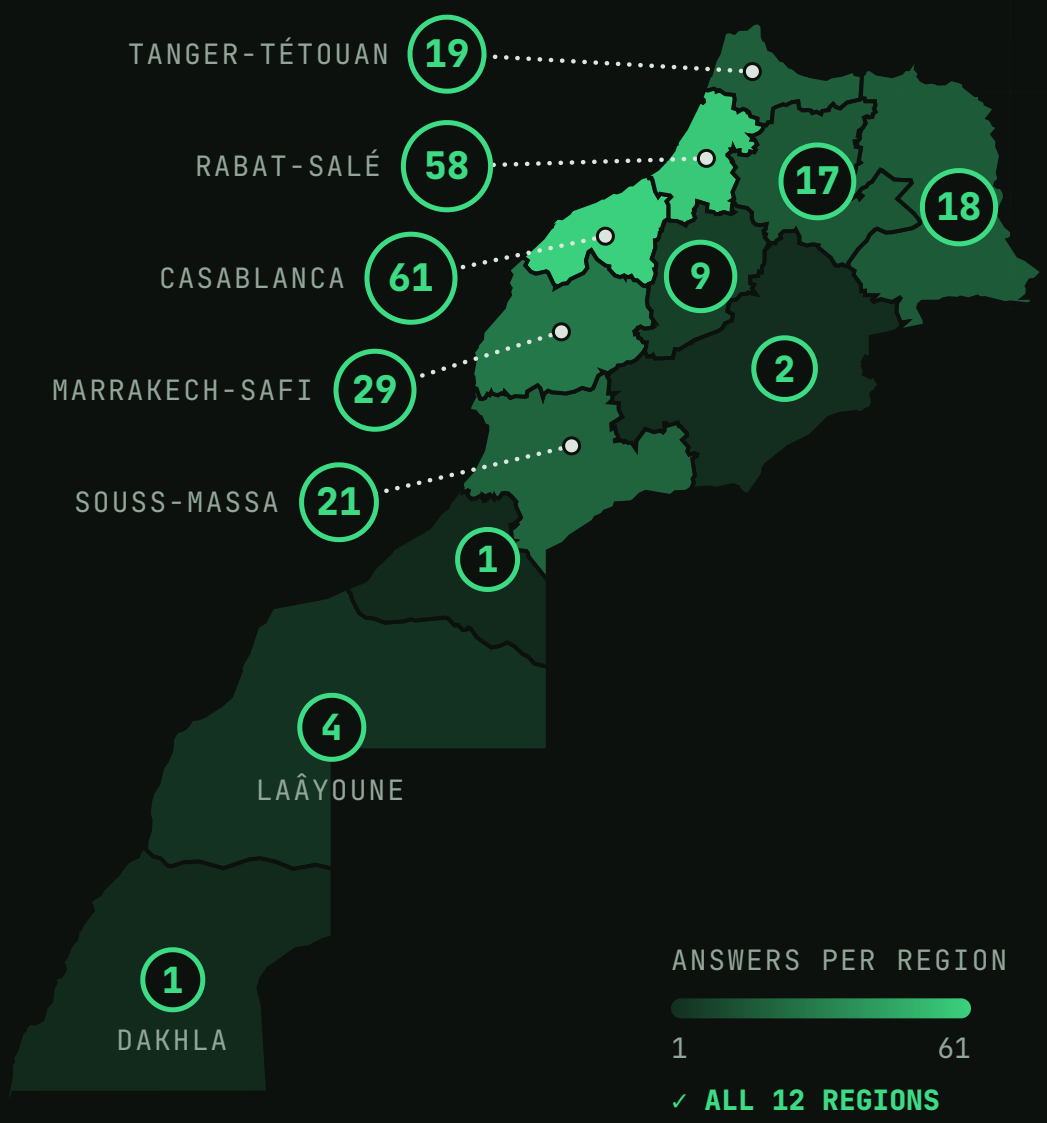
**10%** Employees of foreign companies
Half of them abroad, half working remotely from Morocco

The rest: job seekers 7% · founders 4% · interns 4% · other 2%

> All 12 of Morocco's regions are in. The map is next.

GEOGRAPHIC REACH · 260+ RESPONDENTS

# From Tanger to Laâyoune.




ANSWERS PER REGION

1 61

✓ ALL 12 REGIONS

TOP REGIONS · % OF ALL

| | |
|---|---|
| 23% | Casablanca-Settat |
| 22% | Rabat-Salé-Kénitra |
| 11% | Marrakech-Safi |
| 8% | Souss-Massa |

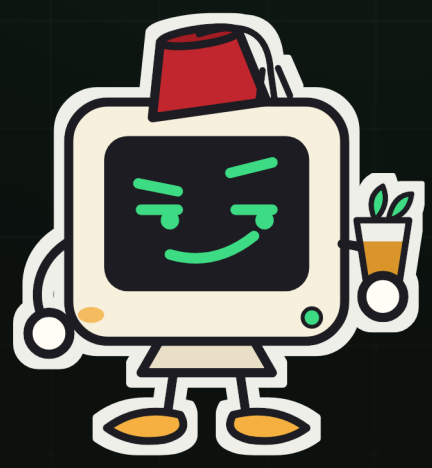
ABROAD · 21 ANSWERS



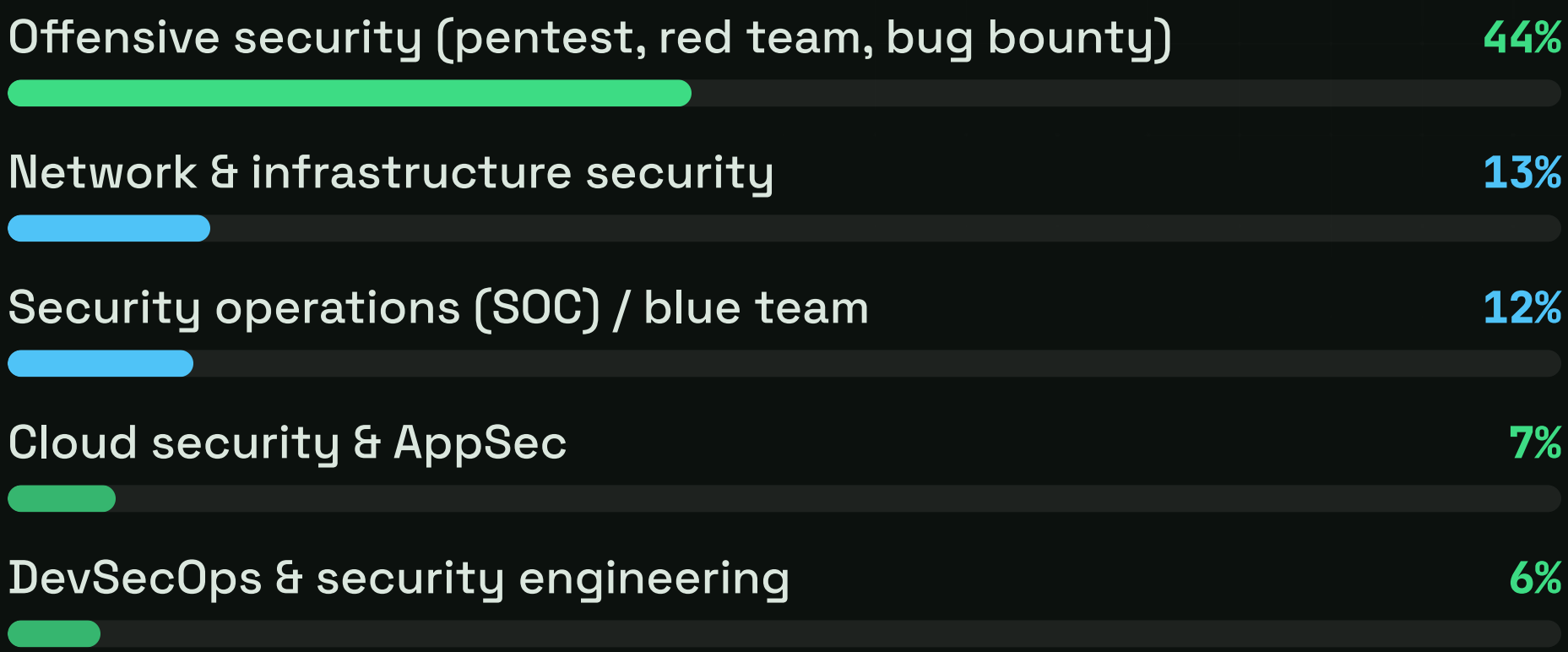

12 of 12 regions have answered, plus 21 from France, the rest of Europe, the Gulf and Africa. **All 12 regions are on the map.**

DOMAIN BREAKDOWN

# The offensive skew.



Morocco loves breaking things. But where are the defenders?

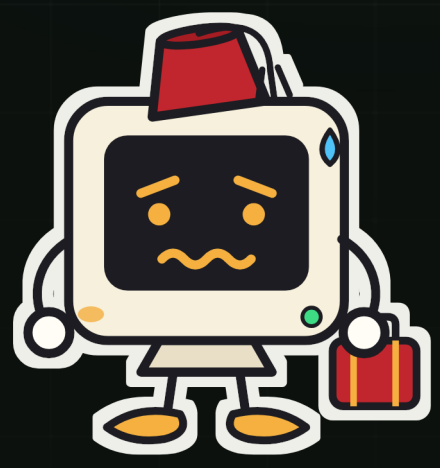



Also: DFIR 3% · GRC 2% · threat intel 2% · CISOs 2%

> SOC analysts & blue teamers: don’t let offensive hackers write the whole report. Add your voice!

MOBILITY & RETENTION

# The departure question.



We asked everyone living in Morocco: **“Do you plan to work outside Morocco?”**

**40%**
“Yes, within 2 years”

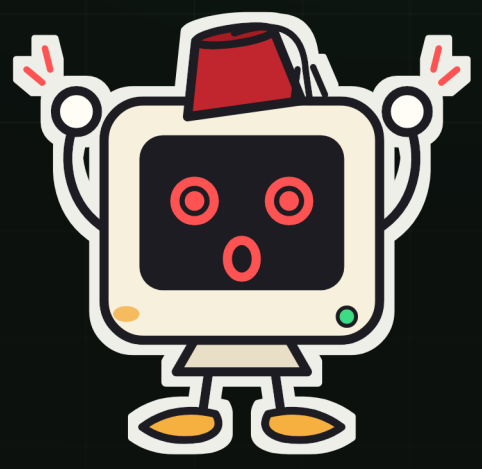
**48%**
“Still hesitating”

**12%**
“No”

Only about **1 in 8** has no plan to work abroad. **88%** are either planning to leave or still weighing it.

REALITY ON THE GROUND

# Reporting bugs in Morocco.



The numbers nobody talks about publicly:

**57%** Say Moroccan law protects good-faith reporters **poorly or not at all**

Only 4% say it protects them well; 25% don’t know

**18%** Were asked to **downgrade a finding** or hide an incident

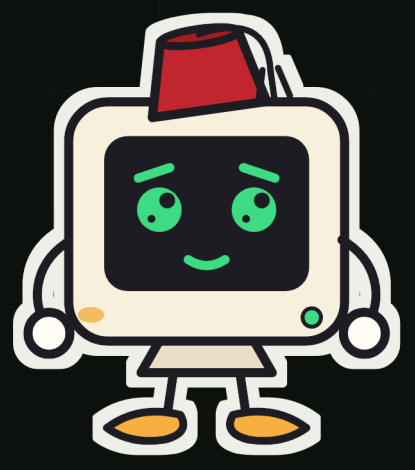
By an employer or client, in the last 3 years

**15%** Got a **legal threat or were told to stay quiet** after reporting a flaw

3 of the 20 who reported one; 8 of the 20 were thanked or rewarded

COMMUNITY CALL

# Who we still need to hear.



The survey stays open. Help us balance the data:

- SOC analysts & blue teams
- GRC, audit & compliance
- CISOs & security managers
- Banking, telecom & industry
- Women in cyber: only 6.5% so far → next slide

> The final report will be **open to everyone.** The more balanced the answers, the truer the benchmark for Moroccan cyber.

THIS ONE IS FOR YOU

# Women in cyber, the mic is yours.

**6.5%**

of the answers so far come from women (17 respondents). **That can't be the whole story.**



- 100% anonymous
- No name, no email
- 10–15 minutes

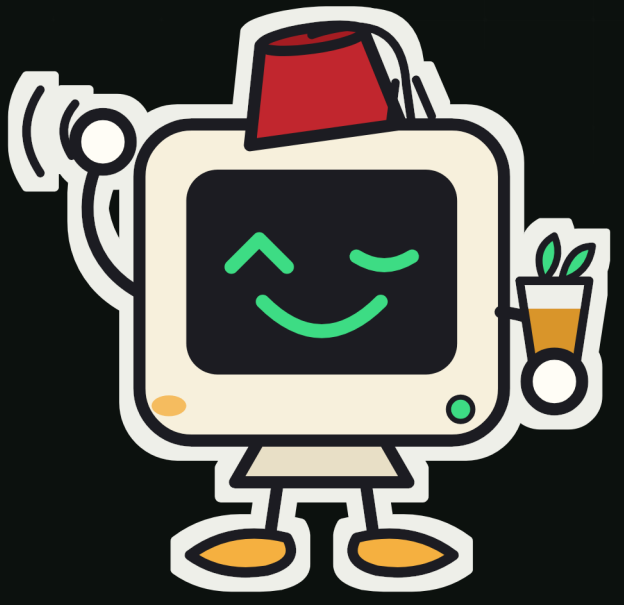
> **Take it, then pass it on** to the women on your team, in your class and in your CTF crew.

SHARE THIS STORY

# Add your voice.
# 10–15 minutes.

100% anonymous · No name · No email.
Open results for everyone.

$ open **stateofsec.ma** scan



← point your camera here
and you are **in**.

Send it to a colleague, a classmate, your SOC team.

CHAPTER 02 LOGGED · PATTERNS IDENTIFIED

# The snapshot counted replies. Rootie looked for the absences.

The data answered some questions, then exposed another: whose perspective was still missing from the frame?

PREVIOUS DISPATCH / 02

## First snapshot

260+ at publication, with all 12 regions represented.

7 NOV 2026 · EARLY DATA

NEXT DISPATCH / 03

## Investigation lens

Rootie reframes the same week as an open case.

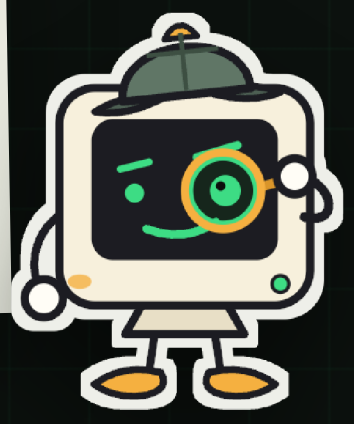
261 ENGAGED · 7 PAGES

FOLLOW THE CLUE

SAME PERIOD / NEW QUESTION

### What did respondents say—and who had not answered yet?

Coverage across every region does not make the sample representative of Morocco's workforce.



• STATE OF SEC MOROCCO · 7-DAY FIELD DOSSIER

# A WEEK AFTER LAUNCHING.

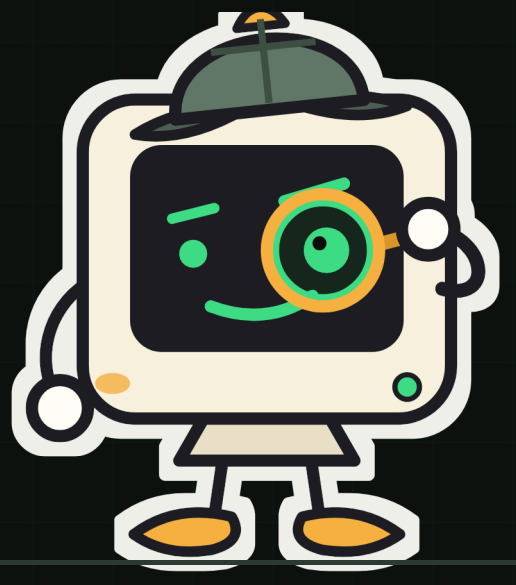
261 Moroccan practitioners, hackers, and students gave their anonymous testimonies. **Inspector Rootie combed through the crime scene. Here is what we found.**

**261**

Defenders & students across all 12 Moroccan regions

**21**

Moroccan cyber minds reporting from the diaspora



• FINDING 01 · THE MONEY MIRROR

# THE TALENT ISN'T MISSING. IT'S UNDERPAID.

Institutions complain of a "talent shortage." The salary data reveals the truth:

LOCAL CEILING VS OFFSHORE REALITY — CONFIDENTIAL DATA

**12,000** MAD / mo ↔ **$100k** / yr

The Moroccan median is **8,000–16,000 MAD net** with a hard local ceiling around 30k. Moroccans abroad earn **80,000–120,000 $** — a 5× multiplier for the exact same skillset.

• Anomaly: 4 bug bounty hunters made over $50,000/yr from home — more than any local corporate wage.

• FINDING 02 · THE MISSING PEAK

# THE GHOST CAPSTONE.

We mapped 213 certification profiles from students to CISOs. Look at the summit:

EXECUTIVE CREDENTIALS DETECTED — CRITICAL FINDING

**0** CISSP / CISM • **1** ISO 27001

The international management tier is completely uncertified. Meanwhile, **46% hold no certs at all**, and the highest earner (>60k) holds only free entry-level certs.

Verdict: Moroccan security promotes tenure, ownership, and internal politics — not paper.

• FINDING 03 · THE LEGAL VOID

# WHY DEFENDERS STAY QUIET.

Why don’t Moroccan researchers report vulnerabilities when they discover them?

“DOES MOROCCAN LAW PROTECT GOOD-FAITH REPORTERS?” OPEN SECRET

**54%** “Poorly or Not at all”

Another **26% don’t know**. Among those who noticed flaws in national systems, **25.5% preferred not to say even anonymously** whether they reported it.

Verdict: In Morocco, silence is not ignorance — it is a calculated self-defense mechanism.

• FINDING 04 · THE 24-MONTH CLOCK

# THE EXIT IS SCHEDULED.

We asked everyone currently in Morocco: **“Do you plan to work outside Morocco?”**

FLIGHT INTENT ACROSS THE RANKS — TELEMETRY

**83%** Gone or Ready to Leave

Only **1 in 8** is committed to staying in Morocco. Crucial insight: **87% of 5+ year veterans are still here today** — the drain is happening over the next 24 months.

Verdict: The window to fix compensation and retain Morocco's senior cyber defenders is closing right now.

• FINDING 05 · THE INVISIBLE FIFTH

# THE 20% NOBODY SPEAKS TO.

When we asked which languages respondents read and write:

COMMUNITY LINGUISTIC PROFILE — HISTORIC FIRST

**20.4%** Amazigh Speakers

**41 practitioners** speak Amazigh — larger than the entire local SOC workforce sample. Two respondents listed **only Amazigh**. Yet not a single Moroccan security guide exists in their tongue.

Verdict: The Moroccan cyber community is culturally richer than French/English corporate decks acknowledge.

• WEEK 2 · FINAL PUSH

# THE DOSSIER IS STILL INCOMPLETE.

261 is a benchmark. **400 makes it unbreakable.**
Help us balance the sample before the case file closes mid-November:

- **SOC Analysts & Blue Teams:** Don't let offensive hackers write the whole report.
- **CISOs & Management:** We need the other side of the budget equation.
- **Women in Cyber:** Currently 6.5% (17 responses). That cannot be the whole story.

→ Take it. Share it. 10 minutes. 100% anonymous.
stateofsec.ma

CHAPTER 03 LOGGED · CASE REMAINS OPEN

# The case file raised the alarm. The dossier tightened the claim.

The final chapter retains the mystery while separating a survey-reach gap from a real workforce gap.

PREVIOUS DISPATCH / 03

## Case-file concept

An urgent recruitment push built around missing voices.

261 ENGAGED · 7 PAGES

NEXT DISPATCH / 04

## Refined dossier

Evidence, denominators and explicit caveats.

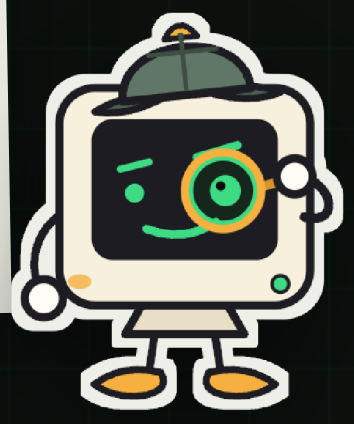
263 ENGAGED · 9 EXHIBITS

CALIBRATION NOTE

### Underrepresented in this sample does not mean absent from Morocco.

Later counts supersede earlier snapshots. The findings describe respondents, not the entire cybersecurity workforce.

OPEN THE DOSSIER

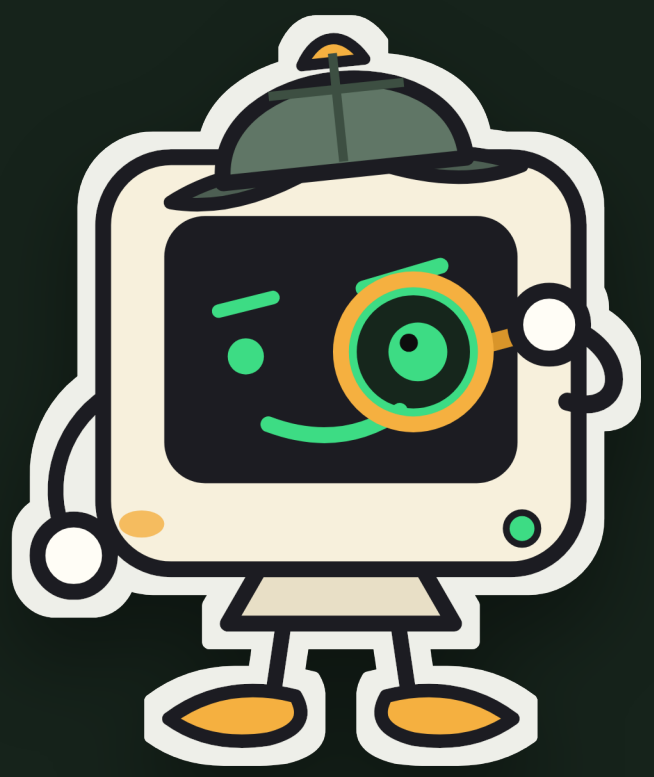


NEW CASE OPENED · WEEK ONE

# The case of the missing cyber profiles.

Offensive security arrived first. Rootie wants to know whether other profiles are scarce—or simply missing from the survey.

ROOTIE / OPEN CASE



EVIDENCE INDEX

- A Who showed up?
- B The certificate wall
- C Follow the money
- D Reporting confidence

WHO ENTERED THE ROOM?

# Not just one crowd.

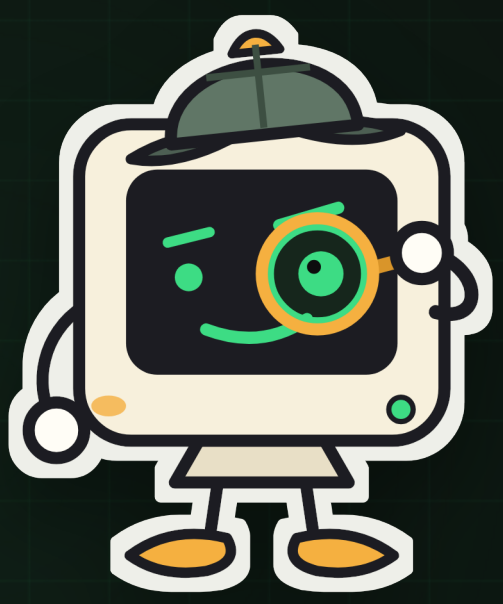
The current survey mix—not an estimate of Morocco's whole cyber workforce.

**30% Employees in Morocco**
76 people · public, private and nearshore organizations

**26% Students**
67 people · universities, schools, 1337, OFPPT and others

**14% Freelancers**
35 people · including full-time bug bounty

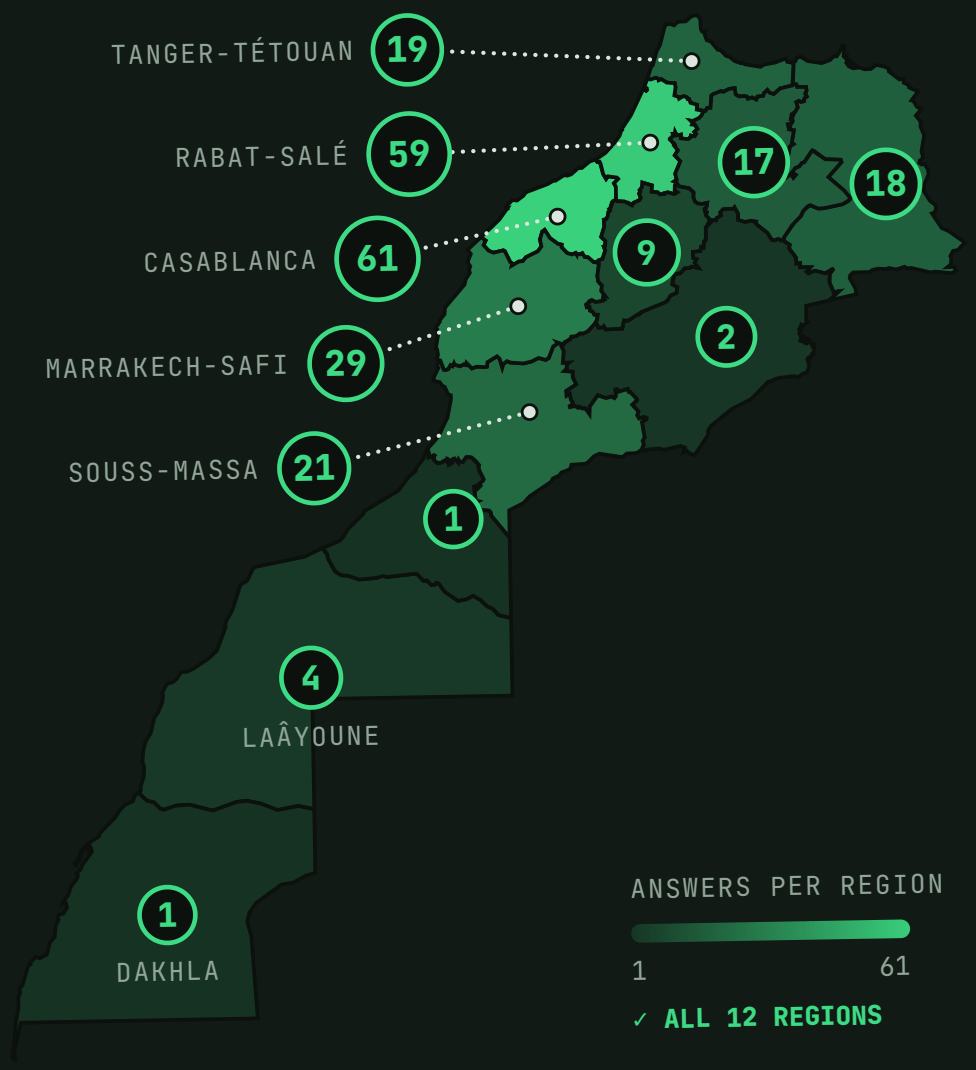
**11% Looking for work**
28 people currently job hunting



ALSO: FOREIGN-COMPANY EMPLOYEES 11% · FOUNDERS 4% · INTERNS 3% · OTHER 2%

THE MAP IS FULL

# Geography covered. Case still open.




ANSWERS PER REGION

1 61

✓ ALL 12 REGIONS

TOP REGIONS · % OF ALL

| | |
|---|---|
| 23% | Casablanca-Settat |
| 22% | Rabat-Salé-Kénitra |
| 11% | Marrakech-Safi |
| 8% | Souss-Massa |

ABROAD · 22 ANSWERS




**Important:** 12/12 regions appearing does not make the sample representative.

WHO ARRIVED FIRST?

# The offensive crowd beat everyone to the scene.

**41%**

**Offensive security**

95 people · pentest, red team or bug bounty

**13%**

Network & infrastructure

**13%**

SOC / blue team

KHADIJA F RH

MA KAYN TA BUREAU

MOUL L'GRC?

L'MAIL KAYRJE3

UNDERREPRESENTED ≠ MA KAYNCH



**10%**

Still exploring

**6%**

Cloud & AppSec

WHICH CERTIFICATIONS DO YOU HOLD?

# Rootie checked the certificate wall. 46% said “not yet.”

CERTIFICATION WALL · n=216

**NONE YET**

**99**

OF 216 · 46%

**AT LEAST ONE**

**117**

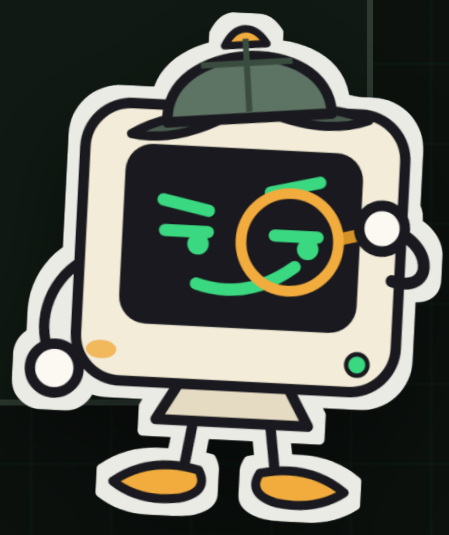
54% OF 216

MOST-CITED BADGES · SELECTIONS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ENTRY-LEVEL / FREE 42 | OSCP 18 | INE / HACK THE BOX 17 |
| HANDS-ON OFFENSIVE 16 | COMPTIA 15 | NETWORK VENDOR 9 |

RARE IN THIS SAMPLE

ISO 27001 / EBIOS · 1 | CISSP / CISM / CISA · 0



THIS WALL DESCRIBES THIS SAMPLE — NOT MOROCCO’S CERTIFIED WORKFORCE.

BUG BOUNTY · LAST 12 MONTHS

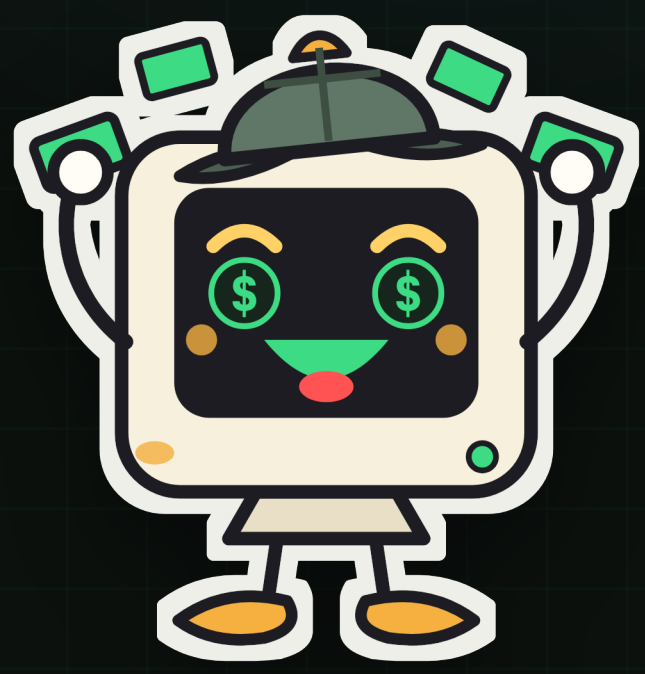
# Follow the money.

## BUG BOUNTY EARNINGS RECEIPT

CURRENCY: USD / PERIOD: LAST 12 MONTHS / RESPONDENTS: 79

| | |
|---|---|
| **No cash**<br>38 reported $0; 7 received swag only | 45 |
| **$1–$49,999**<br>Reported cash earnings | 24 |
| **$50,000+**<br>Reported $50,000 or more | 5 |
| **Prefer not to say** | 5 |
| TOTAL RESPONDENTS ..... | 79 |

SELF-REPORTED · NOT VERIFIED INCOME DATA



FIVE HUGE WINS ≠ TYPICAL

Rootie saw five $50k+ answers and briefly forgot the other 74 people.

PLANNING TO WORK OUTSIDE MOROCCO?

# 41% yes. 41% ma3reft.




| ANSWER | PEOPLE | SHARE |
|---|---|---|
| YES · WITHIN 2 YEARS | 70 | 41% |
| STILL HESITATING | 70 | 41% |
| NO | 31 | 18% |

**PLANS ≠ DEPARTURES**

A checked box is not a boarding pass. These are intentions, not confirmed moves.



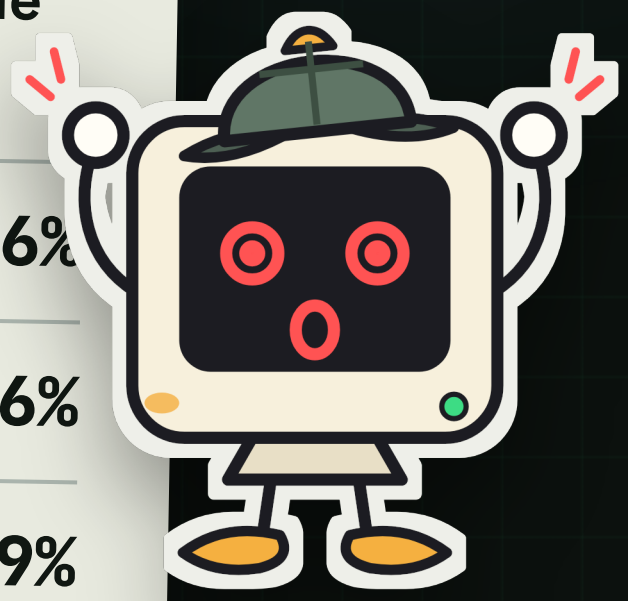
GOOD-FAITH FLAW REPORTING

# Do reporters feel protected?

RESPONDENT CONFIDENCE RECORD [redacted]

How well does Moroccan law protect people who report flaws in good faith?

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ■ Poorly / not at all | 87 | 56% |
| ☐ Don’t know | 40 | 26% |
| ☐ Adequately / well | 29 | 19% |



LOW CONFIDENCE

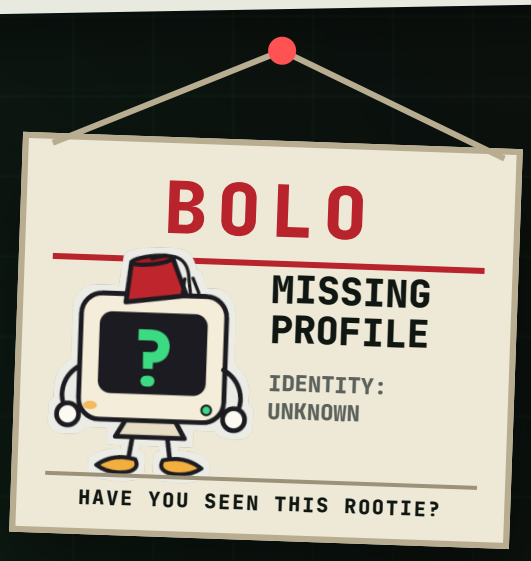
**Case note:** this records perceptions. It is not a legal analysis.

THE EVIDENCE IS INCOMPLETE

# Your profile could be the missing clue.

## UNDERREPRESENTED IN THIS SAMPLE

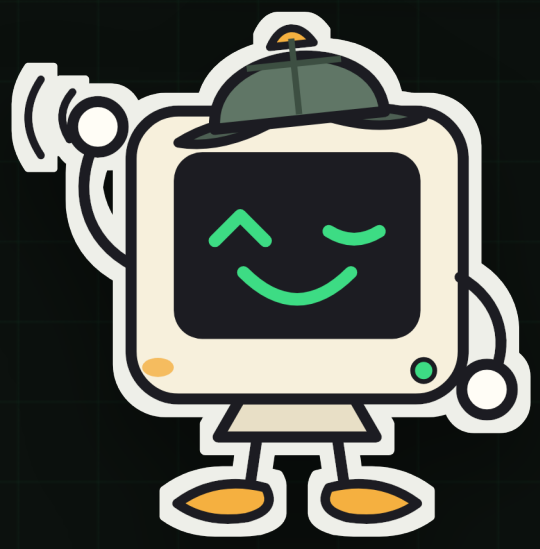
- SOC analysts & blue teams
- Risk, audit & compliance
- Security managers & CISOs
- Banking, telecom, public sector & industry
- Women in cyber · 17 of 263 so far




ADD YOUR CLUE

stateofsec.ma

Anonymous · no name · no email
Open results for everyone.



**If your lane is missing, add it.** More replies can help separate a real workforce gap from a survey reach gap.

**@saladin0x1** and **@mchklt** are putting a huge amount of work into making this happen. This is a not-for-profit community project. Please help by sharing; ideas and feedback are always welcome.